# NEHEMIAH

## JERUSALEM'S WALLS REBUILT

1 The words of Nehemiah the son of Hacaliah.
Now it happened in the month of Chislev, in the
twentieth year, as I was in Susa the citadel, [2]that Hanani, one
of my brothers, came with certain men from Judah. And I
asked them concerning the Jews who escaped, who had sur-
vived the exile, and concerning Jerusalem. [3]And they said to
me, "The remnant there in the province who had survived the
exile is in great trouble and shame. The wall of Jerusalem is
broken down, and its gates are destroyed by fire."

[4]As soon as I heard these words I sat down and wept
and mourned for days, and I continued fasting and pray-
ing before the God of heaven. [5]And I said, "O LORD God of
heaven, the great and awesome God who keeps covenant and
steadfast love with those who love him and keep his com-
mandments, [6]let your ear be attentive and your eyes open,
to hear the prayer of your servant that I now pray before you
day and night for the people of Israel your servants, confess-
ing the sins of the people of Israel, which we have sinned
against you. Even I and my father's house have sinned. [7]We
have acted very corruptly against you and have not kept the
commandments, the statutes, and the rules that you com-
manded your servant Moses. [8]Remember the word that you
commanded your servant Moses, saying, 'If you are unfaith-
ful, I will scatter you among the peoples, [9]but if you return

to me and keep my commandments and do them, though
your outcasts are in the uttermost parts of heaven, from
there I will gather them and bring them to the place that I
have chosen, to make my name dwell there.' [10]They are your
servants and your people, whom you have redeemed by your
great power and by your strong hand. [11]O Lord, let your ear
be attentive to the prayer of your servant, and to the prayer
of your servants who delight to fear your name, and give suc-
cess to your servant today, and grant him mercy in the sight
of this man."

Now I was cupbearer to the king.

2 In the month of Nisan, in the twentieth year of King
Artaxerxes, when wine was before him, I took up the wine and
gave it to the king. Now I had not been sad in his presence.
[2]And the king said to me, "Why is your face sad, seeing you
are not sick? This is nothing but sadness of the heart." Then
I was very much afraid. [3]I said to the king, "Let the king live
forever! Why should not my face be sad, when the city, the
place of my fathers' graves, lies in ruins, and its gates have
been destroyed by fire?" [4]Then the king said to me, "What
are you requesting?" So I prayed to the God of heaven. [5]And
I said to the king, "If it pleases the king, and if your servant
has found favor in your sight, that you send me to Judah, to
the city of my fathers' graves, that I may rebuild it." [6]And the
king said to me (the queen sitting beside him), "How long
will you be gone, and when will you return?" So it pleased the
king to send me when I had given him a time. [7]And I said to
the king, "If it pleases the king, let letters be given me to the





governors of the province Beyond the River, that they may let
me pass through until I come to Judah, [8]and a letter to Asaph,
the keeper of the king's forest, that he may give me timber to
make beams for the gates of the fortress of the temple, and for
the wall of the city, and for the house that I shall occupy." And
the king granted me what I asked, for the good hand of my
God was upon me.

[9]Then I came to the governors of the province Beyond
the River and gave them the king's letters. Now the king had
sent with me officers of the army and horsemen. [10]But when
Sanballat the Horonite and Tobiah the Ammonite servant
heard this, it displeased them greatly that someone had come
to seek the welfare of the people of Israel.

[11]So I went to Jerusalem and was there three days. [12]Then
I arose in the night, I and a few men with me. And I told no
one what my God had put into my heart to do for Jerusalem.
There was no animal with me but the one on which I rode.
[13]I went out by night by the Valley Gate to the Dragon Spring
and to the Dung Gate, and I inspected the walls of Jerusalem
that were broken down and its gates that had been destroyed
by fire. [14]Then I went on to the Fountain Gate and to the
King's Pool, but there was no room for the animal that was
under me to pass. [15]Then I went up in the night by the valley
and inspected the wall, and I turned back and entered by the
Valley Gate, and so returned. [16]And the officials did not know
where I had gone or what I was doing, and I had not yet told
the Jews, the priests, the nobles, the officials, and the rest who
were to do the work.

[17] Then I said to them, "You see the trouble we are in,
how Jerusalem lies in ruins with its gates burned. Come, let
us build the wall of Jerusalem, that we may no longer suffer
derision." [18] And I told them of the hand of my God that had
been upon me for good, and also of the words that the king
had spoken to me. And they said, "Let us rise up and build."
So they strengthened their hands for the good work. [19] But
when Sanballat the Horonite and Tobiah the Ammonite ser-
vant and Geshem the Arab heard of it, they jeered at us and
despised us and said, "What is this thing that you are doing?
Are you rebelling against the king?" [20] Then I replied to them,
"The God of heaven will make us prosper, and we his servants
will arise and build, but you have no portion or right or claim
in Jerusalem."

3 Then Eliashib the high priest rose up with his brothers
the priests, and they built the Sheep Gate. They consecrated
it and set its doors. They consecrated it as far as the Tower of
the Hundred, as far as the Tower of Hananel. [2] And next to him
the men of Jericho built. And next to them Zaccur the son of
Imri built.

[3] The sons of Hassenaah built the Fish Gate. They laid its
beams and set its doors, its bolts, and its bars. [4] And next to
them Meremoth the son of Uriah, son of Hakkoz repaired.
And next to them Meshullam the son of Berechiah, son of
Meshezabel repaired. And next to them Zadok the son of
Baana repaired. [5] And next to them the Tekoites repaired, but
their nobles would not stoop to serve their Lord.

[6] Joiada the son of Paseah and Meshullam the son of





Besodeiah repaired the Gate of Yeshanah. They laid its beams
and set its doors, its bolts, and its bars. [7] And next to them
repaired Melatiah the Gibeonite and Jadon the Meronothite,
the men of Gibeon and of Mizpah, the seat of the governor of
the province Beyond the River. [8] Next to them Uzziel the son
of Harhaiah, goldsmiths, repaired. Next to him Hananiah,
one of the perfumers, repaired, and they restored Jerusalem as
far as the Broad Wall. [9] Next to them Rephaiah the son of Hur,
ruler of half the district of Jerusalem, repaired. [10] Next to them
Jedaiah the son of Harumaph repaired opposite his house.
And next to him Hattush the son of Hashabneiah repaired.
[11] Malchijah the son of Harim and Hasshub the son of Pahath-
moab repaired another section and the Tower of the Ovens.
[12] Next to him Shallum the son of Hallohesh, ruler of half the
district of Jerusalem, repaired, he and his daughters.

[13] Hanun and the inhabitants of Zanoah repaired the Valley
Gate. They rebuilt it and set its doors, its bolts, and its bars, and
repaired a thousand cubits of the wall, as far as the Dung Gate.

[14] Malchijah the son of Rechab, ruler of the district of Beth-
haccherem, repaired the Dung Gate. He rebuilt it and set its
doors, its bolts, and its bars.

[15] And Shallum the son of Col-hozeh, ruler of the district
of Mizpah, repaired the Fountain Gate. He rebuilt it and cov-
ered it and set its doors, its bolts, and its bars. And he built
the wall of the Pool of Shelah of the king's garden, as far as
the stairs that go down from the city of David. [16] After him
Nehemiah the son of Azbuk, ruler of half the district of Beth-
zur, repaired to a point opposite the tombs of David, as far

as the artificial pool, and as far as the house of the mighty
men. [17]After him the Levites repaired: Rehum the son of Bani.
Next to him Hashabiah, ruler of half the district of Keilah,
repaired for his district. [18]After him their brothers repaired:
Bavvai the son of Henadad, ruler of half the district of
Keilah. [19]Next to him Ezer the son of Jeshua, ruler of Mizpah,
repaired another section opposite the ascent to the armory at
the buttress. [20]After him Baruch the son of Zabbai repaired
another section from the buttress to the door of the house
of Eliashib the high priest. [21]After him Meremoth the son of
Uriah, son of Hakkoz repaired another section from the door
of the house of Eliashib to the end of the house of Eliashib.
[22]After him the priests, the men of the surrounding area,
repaired. [23]After them Benjamin and Hasshub repaired oppo-
site their house. After them Azariah the son of Maaseiah, son
of Ananiah repaired beside his own house. [24]After him Binnui
the son of Henadad repaired another section, from the house
of Azariah to the buttress and to the corner. [25]Palal the son of
Uzai repaired opposite the buttress and the tower projecting
from the upper house of the king at the court of the guard.
After him Pedaiah the son of Parosh [26]and the temple servants
living on Ophel repaired to a point opposite the Water Gate
on the east and the projecting tower. [27]After him the Tekoites
repaired another section opposite the great projecting tower
as far as the wall of Ophel.

[28]Above the Horse Gate the priests repaired, each one
opposite his own house. [29]After them Zadok the son of Immer
repaired opposite his own house. After him Shemaiah the son





of Shecaniah, the keeper of the East Gate, repaired. [30]After him
Hananiah the son of Shelemiah and Hanun the sixth son of
Zalaph repaired another section. After him Meshullam the
son of Berechiah repaired opposite his chamber. [31]After him
Malchijah, one of the goldsmiths, repaired as far as the house
of the temple servants and of the merchants, opposite the
Muster Gate, and to the upper chamber of the corner. [32]And
between the upper chamber of the corner and the Sheep Gate
the goldsmiths and the merchants repaired.

4 Now when Sanballat heard that we were building the wall,
he was angry and greatly enraged, and he jeered at the Jews.
[2]And he said in the presence of his brothers and of the army of
Samaria, "What are these feeble Jews doing? Will they restore
it for themselves? Will they sacrifice? Will they finish up in a
day? Will they revive the stones out of the heaps of rubbish,
and burned ones at that?" [3]Tobiah the Ammonite was beside
him, and he said, "Yes, what they are building—if a fox goes
up on it he will break down their stone wall!" [4]Hear, O our
God, for we are despised. Turn back their taunt on their own
heads and give them up to be plundered in a land where they
are captives. [5]Do not cover their guilt, and let not their sin be
blotted out from your sight, for they have provoked you to
anger in the presence of the builders.

[6]So we built the wall. And all the wall was joined together
to half its height, for the people had a mind to work.

[7]But when Sanballat and Tobiah and the Arabs and the
Ammonites and the Ashdodites heard that the repairing of the
walls of Jerusalem was going forward and that the breaches

were beginning to be closed, they were very angry. [8]And they
all plotted together to come and fight against Jerusalem and
to cause confusion in it. [9]And we prayed to our God and set a
guard as a protection against them day and night.

[10]In Judah it was said, "The strength of those who bear the
burdens is failing. There is too much rubble. By ourselves we
will not be able to rebuild the wall." [11]And our enemies said,
"They will not know or see till we come among them and
kill them and stop the work." [12]At that time the Jews who
lived near them came from all directions and said to us ten
times, "You must return to us." [13]So in the lowest parts of the
space behind the wall, in open places, I stationed the people by their clans, with their swords, their spears, and their
bows. [14]And I looked and arose and said to the nobles and to
the officials and to the rest of the people, "Do not be afraid
of them. Remember the Lord, who is great and awesome,
and fight for your brothers, your sons, your daughters, your
wives, and your homes."

[15]When our enemies heard that it was known to us and that
God had frustrated their plan, we all returned to the wall, each
to his work. [16]From that day on, half of my servants worked
on construction, and half held the spears, shields, bows, and
coats of mail. And the leaders stood behind the whole house
of Judah, [17]who were building on the wall. Those who carried
burdens were loaded in such a way that each labored on the
work with one hand and held his weapon with the other.
[18]And each of the builders had his sword strapped at his side
while he built. The man who sounded the trumpet was beside





me. [19]And I said to the nobles and to the officials and to the
rest of the people, "The work is great and widely spread, and
we are separated on the wall, far from one another. [20]In the
place where you hear the sound of the trumpet, rally to us
there. Our God will fight for us."

[21]So we labored at the work, and half of them held the
spears from the break of dawn until the stars came out. [22]I also
said to the people at that time, "Let every man and his servant
pass the night within Jerusalem, that they may be a guard for
us by night and may labor by day." [23]So neither I nor my brothers nor my servants nor the men of the guard who followed
me, none of us took off our clothes; each kept his weapon at
his right hand.

5 Now there arose a great outcry of the people and of their
wives against their Jewish brothers. [2]For there were those who
said, "With our sons and our daughters, we are many. So let
us get grain, that we may eat and keep alive." [3]There were also
those who said, "We are mortgaging our fields, our vineyards,
and our houses to get grain because of the famine." [4]And there
were those who said, "We have borrowed money for the king's
tax on our fields and our vineyards. [5]Now our flesh is as the
flesh of our brothers, our children are as their children. Yet
we are forcing our sons and our daughters to be slaves, and
some of our daughters have already been enslaved, but it is
not in our power to help it, for other men have our fields and
our vineyards."

[6]I was very angry when I heard their outcry and these
words. [7]I took counsel with myself, and I brought charges

against the nobles and the officials. I said to them, "You are
exacting interest, each from his brother." And I held a great
assembly against them [8] and said to them, "We, as far as we
are able, have bought back our Jewish brothers who have
been sold to the nations, but you even sell your brothers that
they may be sold to us!" They were silent and could not find
a word to say. [9] So I said, "The thing that you are doing is not
good. Ought you not to walk in the fear of our God to prevent
the taunts of the nations our enemies? [10] Moreover, I and my
brothers and my servants are lending them money and grain.
Let us abandon this exacting of interest. [11] Return to them this
very day their fields, their vineyards, their olive orchards, and
their houses, and the percentage of money, grain, wine, and
oil that you have been exacting from them." [12] Then they said,
"We will restore these and require nothing from them. We
will do as you say." And I called the priests and made them
swear to do as they had promised. [13] I also shook out the fold of
my garment and said, "So may God shake out every man from
his house and from his labor who does not keep this promise.
So may he be shaken out and emptied." And all the assembly
said "Amen" and praised the LORD. And the people did as they
had promised.

[14] Moreover, from the time that I was appointed to be their
governor in the land of Judah, from the twentieth year to the
thirty-second year of Artaxerxes the king, twelve years, nei-
ther I nor my brothers ate the food allowance of the gover-
nor. [15] The former governors who were before me laid heavy
burdens on the people and took from them for their daily





ration forty shekels of silver. Even their servants lorded it over
the people. But I did not do so, because of the fear of God.
[16] I also persevered in the work on this wall, and we acquired
no land, and all my servants were gathered there for the work.
[17] Moreover, there were at my table 150 men, Jews and offi-
cials, besides those who came to us from the nations that were
around us. [18] Now what was prepared at my expense for each
day was one ox and six choice sheep and birds, and every ten
days all kinds of wine in abundance. Yet for all this I did not
demand the food allowance of the governor, because the ser-
vice was too heavy on this people. [19] Remember for my good,
O my God, all that I have done for this people.

6 Now when Sanballat and Tobiah and Geshem the Arab
and the rest of our enemies heard that I had built the wall
and that there was no breach left in it (although up to that
time I had not set up the doors in the gates), [2] Sanballat and
Geshem sent to me, saying, "Come and let us meet together
at Hakkephirim in the plain of Ono." But they intended to
do me harm. [3] And I sent messengers to them, saying, "I am
doing a great work and I cannot come down. Why should the
work stop while I leave it and come down to you?" [4] And they
sent to me four times in this way, and I answered them in the
same manner. [5] In the same way Sanballat for the fifth time
sent his servant to me with an open letter in his hand. [6] In it
was written, "It is reported among the nations, and Geshem
also says it, that you and the Jews intend to rebel; that is why
you are building the wall. And according to these reports
you wish to become their king. [7] And you have also set up

prophets to proclaim concerning you in Jerusalem, 'There is
a king in Judah.' And now the king will hear of these reports.
So now come and let us take counsel together." [8]Then I sent
to him, saying, "No such things as you say have been done,
for you are inventing them out of your own mind." [9]For they
all wanted to frighten us, thinking, "Their hands will drop
from the work, and it will not be done." But now, O God,
strengthen my hands.

[10]Now when I went into the house of Shemaiah the son
of Delaiah, son of Mehetabel, who was confined to his home,
he said, "Let us meet together in the house of God, within
the temple. Let us close the doors of the temple, for they are
coming to kill you. They are coming to kill you by night."
[11]But I said, "Should such a man as I run away? And what man
such as I could go into the temple and live? I will not go in."
[12]And I understood and saw that God had not sent him, but
he had pronounced the prophecy against me because Tobiah
and Sanballat had hired him. [13]For this purpose he was hired,
that I should be afraid and act in this way and sin, and so they
could give me a bad name in order to taunt me. [14]Remember
Tobiah and Sanballat, O my God, according to these things
that they did, and also the prophetess Noadiah and the rest of
the prophets who wanted to make me afraid.

[15]So the wall was finished on the twenty-fifth day of the
month Elul, in fifty-two days. [16]And when all our enemies
heard of it, all the nations around us were afraid and fell
greatly in their own esteem, for they perceived that this work
had been accomplished with the help of our God. [17]Moreover,





in those days the nobles of Judah sent many letters to Tobiah,
and Tobiah's letters came to them. [18]For many in Judah were
bound by oath to him, because he was the son-in-law of
Shecaniah the son of Arah: and his son Jehohanan had taken
the daughter of Meshullam the son of Berechiah as his wife.
[19]Also they spoke of his good deeds in my presence and reported
my words to him. And Tobiah sent letters to make me afraid.

7 Now when the wall had been built and I had set up the
doors, and the gatekeepers, the singers, and the Levites had
been appointed, [2]I gave my brother Hanani and Hananiah
the governor of the castle charge over Jerusalem, for he was a
more faithful and God-fearing man than many. [3]And I said to
them, "Let not the gates of Jerusalem be opened until the sun
is hot. And while they are still standing guard, let them shut
and bar the doors. Appoint guards from among the inhabi-
tants of Jerusalem, some at their guard posts and some in
front of their own homes." [4]The city was wide and large, but
the people within it were few, and no houses had been rebuilt.

[5]Then my God put it into my heart to assemble the nobles
and the officials and the people to be enrolled by genealogy.
And I found the book of the genealogy of those who came up
at the first, and I found written in it:

[6]These were the people of the province who came up out of
the captivity of those exiles whom Nebuchadnezzar the king
of Babylon had carried into exile. They returned to Jerusalem
and Judah, each to his town. [7]They came with Zerubbabel,
Jeshua, Nehemiah, Azariah, Raamiah, Nahamani, Mordecai,
Bilshan, Mispereth, Bigvai, Nehum, Baanah.

The number of the men of the people of Israel: [8] the sons
of Parosh, 2,172. [9] The sons of Shephatiah, 372. [10] The sons of
Arah, 652. [11] The sons of Pahath-moab, namely the sons of
Jeshua and Joab, 2,818. [12] The sons of Elam, 1,254. [13] The sons
of Zattu, 845. [14] The sons of Zaccai, 760. [15] The sons of Binnui,
648. [16] The sons of Bebai, 628. [17] The sons of Azgad, 2,322. [18] The
sons of Adonikam, 667. [19] The sons of Bigvai, 2,067. [20] The sons
of Adin, 655. [21] The sons of Ater, namely of Hezekiah, 98. [22] The
sons of Hashum, 328. [23] The sons of Bezai, 324. [24] The sons of
Hariph, 112. [25] The sons of Gibeon, 95. [26] The men of Bethlehem
and Netophah, 188. [27] The men of Anathoth, 128. [28] The men of
Beth-azmaveth, 42. [29] The men of Kiriath-jearim, Chephirah,
and Beeroth, 743. [30] The men of Ramah and Geba, 621. [31] The
men of Michmas, 122. [32] The men of Bethel and Ai, 123. [33] The
men of the other Nebo, 52. [34] The sons of the other Elam, 1,254.
[35] The sons of Harim, 320. [36] The sons of Jericho, 345. [37] The sons
of Lod, Hadid, and Ono, 721. [38] The sons of Senaah, 3,930.

[39] The priests: the sons of Jedaiah, namely the house of
Jeshua, 973. [40] The sons of Immer, 1,052. [41] The sons of Pashhur,
1,247. [42] The sons of Harim, 1,017.

[43] The Levites: the sons of Jeshua, namely of Kadmiel of the
sons of Hodevah, 74. [44] The singers: the sons of Asaph, 148.
[45] The gatekeepers: the sons of Shallum, the sons of Ater, the
sons of Talmon, the sons of Akkub, the sons of Hatita, the
sons of Shobai, 138.

[46] The temple servants: the sons of Ziha, the sons of Hasupha,
the sons of Tabbaoth, [47] the sons of Keros, the sons of Sia, the
sons of Padon, [48] the sons of Lebana, the sons of Hagaba, the





sons of Shalmai, [49] the sons of Hanan, the sons of Giddel, the
sons of Gahar, [50] the sons of Reaiah, the sons of Rezin, the sons
of Nekoda, [51] the sons of Gazzam, the sons of Uzza, the sons
of Paseah, [52] the sons of Besai, the sons of Meunim, the sons of
Nephushesim, [53] the sons of Bakbuk, the sons of Hakupha, the
sons of Harhur, [54] the sons of Bazlith, the sons of Mehida, the
sons of Harsha, [55] the sons of Barkos, the sons of Sisera, the sons
of Temah, [56] the sons of Neziah, the sons of Hatipha.

[57] The sons of Solomon's servants: the sons of Sotai, the sons
of Sophereth, the sons of Perida, [58] the sons of Jaala, the sons of
Darkon, the sons of Giddel, [59] the sons of Shephatiah, the sons
of Hattil, the sons of Pochereth-hazzebaim, the sons of Amon.

[60] All the temple servants and the sons of Solomon's ser-
vants were 392.

[61] The following were those who came up from Tel-melah,
Tel-harsha, Cherub, Addon, and Immer, but they could not
prove their fathers' houses nor their descent, whether they
belonged to Israel: [62] the sons of Delaiah, the sons of Tobiah, the
sons of Nekoda, 642. [63] Also, of the priests: the sons of Hobaiah,
the sons of Hakkoz, the sons of Barzillai (who had taken a wife
of the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite and was called by
their name). [64] These sought their registration among those
enrolled in the genealogies, but it was not found there, so they
were excluded from the priesthood as unclean. [65] The governor
told them that they were not to partake of the most holy food
until a priest with Urim and Thummim should arise.

[66] The whole assembly together was 42,360, [67] besides their
male and female servants, of whom there were 7,337. And they

had 245 singers, male and female. [68]Their horses were 736,
their mules 245, [69]their camels 435, and their donkeys 6,720.

[70]Now some of the heads of fathers' houses gave to the
work. The governor gave to the treasury 1,000 darics of gold,
50 basins, 30 priests' garments and 500 minas of silver. [71]And
some of the heads of fathers' houses gave into the treasury of
the work 20,000 darics of gold and 2,200 minas of silver. [72]And
what the rest of the people gave was 20,000 darics of gold,
2,000 minas of silver, and 67 priests' garments.

[73]So the priests, the Levites, the gatekeepers, the singers,
some of the people, the temple servants, and all Israel, lived
in their towns.

And when the seventh month had come, the people of
Israel were in their towns.

## COVENANT RENEWAL AND REFORMS

8 And all the people gathered as one man into the square
before the Water Gate. And they told Ezra the scribe to
bring the Book of the Law of Moses that the LORD had com-
manded Israel. [2]So Ezra the priest brought the Law before the
assembly, both men and women and all who could under-
stand what they heard, on the first day of the seventh month.
[3]And he read from it facing the square before the Water
Gate from early morning until midday, in the presence of
the men and the women and those who could understand.
And the ears of all the people were attentive to the Book of





the Law. [4]And Ezra the scribe stood on a wooden platform
that they had made for the purpose. And beside him stood
Mattithiah, Shema, Anaiah, Uriah, Hilkiah, and Maaseiah on
his right hand, and Pedaiah, Mishael, Malchijah, Hashum,
Hashbaddanah, Zechariah, and Meshullam on his left hand.
[5]And Ezra opened the book in the sight of all the people, for
he was above all the people, and as he opened it all the peo-
ple stood. [6]And Ezra blessed the LORD, the great God, and
all the people answered, "Amen, Amen," lifting up their
hands. And they bowed their heads and worshiped the LORD
with their faces to the ground. [7]Also Jeshua, Bani, Shere-
biah, Jamin, Akkub, Shabbethai, Hodiah, Maaseiah, Kelita,
Azariah, Jozabad, Hanan, Pelaiah, the Levites, helped the
people to understand the Law, while the people remained in
their places. [8]They read from the book, from the Law of God,
clearly, and they gave the sense, so that the people under-
stood the reading.

[9]And Nehemiah, who was the governor, and Ezra the
priest and scribe, and the Levites who taught the people said
to all the people, "This day is holy to the LORD your God; do
not mourn or weep." For all the people wept as they heard
the words of the Law. [10]Then he said to them, "Go your way.
Eat the fat and drink sweet wine and send portions to anyone
who has nothing ready, for this day is holy to our Lord. And do
not be grieved, for the joy of the LORD is your strength." [11]So
the Levites calmed all the people, saying, "Be quiet, for this
day is holy; do not be grieved." [12]And all the people went their
way to eat and drink and to send portions and to make great

rejoicing, because they had understood the words that were
declared to them.

[13] On the second day the heads of fathers' houses of all
the people, with the priests and the Levites, came together
to Ezra the scribe in order to study the words of the Law.
[14] And they found it written in the Law that the LORD had
commanded by Moses that the people of Israel should dwell
in booths during the feast of the seventh month, [15] and that
they should proclaim it and publish it in all their towns
and in Jerusalem, "Go out to the hills and bring branches of
olive, wild olive, myrtle, palm, and other leafy trees to make
booths, as it is written." [16] So the people went out and brought
them and made booths for themselves, each on his roof, and
in their courts and in the courts of the house of God, and in
the square at the Water Gate and in the square at the Gate of
Ephraim. [17] And all the assembly of those who had returned
from the captivity made booths and lived in the booths, for
from the days of Jeshua the son of Nun to that day the people
of Israel had not done so. And there was very great rejoicing.
[18] And day by day, from the first day to the last day, he read
from the Book of the Law of God. They kept the feast seven
days, and on the eighth day there was a solemn assembly,
according to the rule.

9 Now on the twenty-fourth day of this month the people
of Israel were assembled with fasting and in sackcloth, and
with earth on their heads. [2] And the Israelites separated them-
selves from all foreigners and stood and confessed their sins
and the iniquities of their fathers. [3] And they stood up in their





place and read from the Book of the Law of the LORD their
God for a quarter of the day; for another quarter of it they
made confession and worshiped the LORD their God. [4] On the
stairs of the Levites stood Jeshua, Bani, Kadmiel, Shebaniah,
Bunni, Sherebiah, Bani, and Chenani; and they cried with a
loud voice to the LORD their God. [5] Then the Levites, Jeshua,
Kadmiel, Bani, Hashabneiah, Sherebiah, Hodiah, Shebaniah,
and Pethahiah, said, "Stand up and bless the LORD your God
from everlasting to everlasting. Blessed be your glorious
name, which is exalted above all blessing and praise.

[6] "You are the LORD, you alone. You have made heaven, the
heaven of heavens, with all their host, the earth and all that is
on it, the seas and all that is in them; and you preserve all of
them; and the host of heaven worships you. [7] You are the LORD,
the God who chose Abram and brought him out of Ur of the
Chaldeans and gave him the name Abraham. [8] You found his
heart faithful before you, and made with him the covenant to
give to his offspring the land of the Canaanite, the Hittite, the
Amorite, the Perizzite, the Jebusite, and the Girgashite. And
you have kept your promise, for you are righteous.

[9] "And you saw the affliction of our fathers in Egypt and
heard their cry at the Red Sea, [10] and performed signs and won-
ders against Pharaoh and all his servants and all the people
of his land, for you knew that they acted arrogantly against
our fathers. And you made a name for yourself, as it is to this
day. [11] And you divided the sea before them, so that they went
through the midst of the sea on dry land, and you cast their
pursuers into the depths, as a stone into mighty waters. [12] By a

pillar of cloud you led them in the day, and by a pillar of fire
in the night to light for them the way in which they should
go. [13] You came down on Mount Sinai and spoke with them
from heaven and gave them right rules and true laws, good
statutes and commandments, [14] and you made known to them
your holy Sabbath and commanded them commandments
and statutes and a law by Moses your servant. [15] You gave them
bread from heaven for their hunger and brought water for
them out of the rock for their thirst, and you told them to go
in to possess the land that you had sworn to give them.

[16] "But they and our fathers acted presumptuously and
stiffened their neck and did not obey your commandments.
[17] They refused to obey and were not mindful of the wonders
that you performed among them, but they stiffened their neck
and appointed a leader to return to their slavery in Egypt. But
you are a God ready to forgive, gracious and merciful, slow to
anger and abounding in steadfast love, and did not forsake
them. [18] Even when they had made for themselves a golden
calf and said, 'This is your God who brought you up out of
Egypt,' and had committed great blasphemies, [19] you in your
great mercies did not forsake them in the wilderness. The pil-
lar of cloud to lead them in the way did not depart from them
by day, nor the pillar of fire by night to light for them the
way by which they should go. [20] You gave your good Spirit to
instruct them and did not withhold your manna from their
mouth and gave them water for their thirst. [21] Forty years you
sustained them in the wilderness, and they lacked nothing.
Their clothes did not wear out and their feet did not swell.





[22] "And you gave them kingdoms and peoples and allotted
to them every corner. So they took possession of the land of
Sihon king of Heshbon and the land of Og king of Bashan.
[23] You multiplied their children as the stars of heaven, and
you brought them into the land that you had told their
fathers to enter and possess. [24] So the descendants went in
and possessed the land, and you subdued before them the
inhabitants of the land, the Canaanites, and gave them into
their hand, with their kings and the peoples of the land,
that they might do with them as they would. [25] And they
captured fortified cities and a rich land, and took posses-
sion of houses full of all good things, cisterns already hewn,
vineyards, olive orchards and fruit trees in abundance. So
they ate and were filled and became fat and delighted them-
selves in your great goodness.

[26] "Nevertheless, they were disobedient and rebelled
against you and cast your law behind their back and killed
your prophets, who had warned them in order to turn
them back to you, and they committed great blasphemies.
[27] Therefore you gave them into the hand of their enemies,
who made them suffer. And in the time of their suffering
they cried out to you and you heard them from heaven, and
according to your great mercies you gave them saviors who
saved them from the hand of their enemies. [28] But after they
had rest they did evil again before you, and you abandoned
them to the hand of their enemies, so that they had domin-
ion over them. Yet when they turned and cried to you, you
heard from heaven, and many times you delivered them

according to your mercies. [29]And you warned them in order
to turn them back to your law. Yet they acted presumptu-
ously and did not obey your commandments, but sinned
against your rules, which if a person does them, he shall live
by them, and they turned a stubborn shoulder and stiffened
their neck and would not obey. [30]Many years you bore with
them and warned them by your Spirit through your proph-
ets. Yet they would not give ear. Therefore you gave them
into the hand of the peoples of the lands. [31]Nevertheless, in
your great mercies you did not make an end of them or for-
sake them, for you are a gracious and merciful God.

[32]"Now, therefore, our God, the great, the mighty, and
the awesome God, who keeps covenant and steadfast love,
let not all the hardship seem little to you that has come upon
us, upon our kings, our princes, our priests, our prophets,
our fathers, and all your people, since the time of the kings
of Assyria until this day. [33]Yet you have been righteous in all
that has come upon us, for you have dealt faithfully and we
have acted wickedly. [34]Our kings, our princes, our priests,
and our fathers have not kept your law or paid attention to
your commandments and your warnings that you gave them.
[35]Even in their own kingdom, and amid your great goodness
that you gave them, and in the large and rich land that you
set before them, they did not serve you or turn from their
wicked works. [36]Behold, we are slaves this day; in the land
that you gave to our fathers to enjoy its fruit and its good
gifts, behold, we are slaves. [37]And its rich yield goes to the
kings whom you have set over us because of our sins. They





rule over our bodies and over our livestock as they please,
and we are in great distress.

[38]"Because of all this we make a firm covenant in writing;
on the sealed document are the names of our princes, our
Levites, and our priests.

10 "On the seals are the names of Nehemiah the governor,
the son of Hacaliah, Zedekiah, [2]Seraiah, Azariah, Jeremiah,
[3]Pashhur, Amariah, Malchijah, [4]Hattush, Shebaniah, Malluch,
[5]Harim, Meremoth, Obadiah, [6]Daniel, Ginnethon, Baruch,
[7]Meshullam, Abijah, Mijamin, [8]Maaziah, Bilgai, Shemaiah;
these are the priests. [9]And the Levites: Jeshua the son of Azaniah,
Binnui of the sons of Henadad, Kadmiel; [10]and their brothers,
Shebaniah, Hodiah, Kelita, Pelaiah, Hanan, [11]Mica, Rehob,
Hashabiah, [12]Zaccur, Sherebiah, Shebaniah, [13]Hodiah, Bani,
Beninu. [14]The chiefs of the people: Parosh, Pahath-moab, Elam,
Zattu, Bani, [15]Bunni, Azgad, Bebai, [16]Adonijah, Bigvai, Adin,
[17]Ater, Hezekiah, Azzur, [18]Hodiah, Hashum, Bezai, [19]Hariph,
Anathoth, Nebai, [20]Magpiash, Meshullam, Hezir, [21]Meshezabel,
Zadok, Jaddua, [22]Pelatiah, Hanan, Anaiah, [23]Hoshea, Hananiah,
Hasshub, [24]Hallohesh, Pilha, Shobek, [25]Rehum, Hashabnah,
Maaseiah, [26]Ahiah, Hanan, Anan, [27]Malluch, Harim, Baanah.

[28]"The rest of the people, the priests, the Levites, the gate-
keepers, the singers, the temple servants, and all who have
separated themselves from the peoples of the lands to the
Law of God, their wives, their sons, their daughters, all who
have knowledge and understanding, [29]join with their broth-
ers, their nobles, and enter into a curse and an oath to walk in
God's Law that was given by Moses the servant of God, and to

observe and do all the commandments of the LORD our Lord
and his rules and his statutes. [30]We will not give our daughters
to the peoples of the land or take their daughters for our sons.
[31]And if the peoples of the land bring in goods or any grain
on the Sabbath day to sell, we will not buy from them on the
Sabbath or on a holy day. And we will forego the crops of the
seventh year and the exaction of every debt.

[32]"We also take on ourselves the obligation to give yearly a
third part of a shekel for the service of the house of our God:
[33]for the showbread, the regular grain offering, the regular
burnt offering, the Sabbaths, the new moons, the appointed
feasts, the holy things, and the sin offerings to make atone-
ment for Israel, and for all the work of the house of our
God. [34]We, the priests, the Levites, and the people, have
likewise cast lots for the wood offering, to bring it into the
house of our God, according to our fathers' houses, at times
appointed, year by year, to burn on the altar of the LORD our
God, as it is written in the Law. [35]We obligate ourselves to
bring the firstfruits of our ground and the firstfruits of all
fruit of every tree, year by year, to the house of the LORD;
[36]also to bring to the house of our God, to the priests who
minister in the house of our God, the firstborn of our sons
and of our cattle, as it is written in the Law, and the first-
born of our herds and of our flocks; [37]and to bring the first
of our dough, and our contributions, the fruit of every tree,
the wine and the oil, to the priests, to the chambers of the
house of our God; and to bring to the Levites the tithes from
our ground, for it is the Levites who collect the tithes in all





our towns where we labor. [38]And the priest, the son of Aaron,
shall be with the Levites when the Levites receive the tithes.
And the Levites shall bring up the tithe of the tithes to the
house of our God, to the chambers of the storehouse. [39]For
the people of Israel and the sons of Levi shall bring the con-
tribution of grain, wine, and oil to the chambers, where the
vessels of the sanctuary are, as well as the priests who minis-
ter, and the gatekeepers and the singers. We will not neglect
the house of our God."

11 Now the leaders of the people lived in Jerusalem. And the
rest of the people cast lots to bring one out of ten to live in
Jerusalem the holy city, while nine out of ten remained in the
other towns. [2]And the people blessed all the men who will-
ingly offered to live in Jerusalem.

[3]These are the chiefs of the province who lived in
Jerusalem; but in the towns of Judah everyone lived on his
property in their towns: Israel, the priests, the Levites, the
temple servants, and the descendants of Solomon's servants.
[4]And in Jerusalem lived certain of the sons of Judah and of the
sons of Benjamin. Of the sons of Judah: Athaiah the son of
Uzziah, son of Zechariah, son of Amariah, son of Shephatiah,
son of Mahalalel, of the sons of Perez; [5]and Maaseiah the son
of Baruch, son of Col-hozeh, son of Hazaiah, son of Adaiah,
son of Joiarib, son of Zechariah, son of the Shilonite. [6]All the
sons of Perez who lived in Jerusalem were 468 valiant men.

[7]And these are the sons of Benjamin: Sallu the son of
Meshullam, son of Joed, son of Pedaiah, son of Kolaiah, son
of Maaseiah, son of Ithiel, son of Jeshaiah, [8]and his brothers,

men of valor, 928. [9] Joel the son of Zichri was their overseer;
and Judah the son of Hassenuah was second over the city.

[10] Of the priests: Jedaiah the son of Joiarib, Jachin, [11] Seraiah
the son of Hilkiah, son of Meshullam, son of Zadok, son of
Meraioth, son of Ahitub, ruler of the house of God, [12] and their
brothers who did the work of the house, 822; and Adaiah the
son of Jeroham, son of Pelaliah, son of Amzi, son of Zechariah,
son of Pashhur, son of Malchijah, [13] and his brothers, heads of
fathers' houses, 242; and Amashsai, the son of Azarel, son of
Ahzai, son of Meshillemoth, son of Immer, [14] and their broth-
ers, mighty men of valor, 128; their overseer was Zabdiel the
son of Haggedolim.

[15] And of the Levites: Shemaiah the son of Hasshub, son of
Azrikam, son of Hashabiah, son of Bunni; [16] and Shabbethai
and Jozabad, of the chiefs of the Levites, who were over the
outside work of the house of God; [17] and Mattaniah the son of
Mica, son of Zabdi, son of Asaph, who was the leader of the
praise, who gave thanks, and Bakbukiah, the second among
his brothers; and Abda the son of Shammua, son of Galal, son
of Jeduthun. [18] All the Levites in the holy city were 284.

[19] The gatekeepers, Akkub, Talmon and their brothers, who
kept watch at the gates, were 172. [20] And the rest of Israel, and
of the priests and the Levites, were in all the towns of Judah,
every one in his inheritance. [21] But the temple servants lived
on Ophel; and Ziha and Gishpa were over the temple servants.

[22] The overseer of the Levites in Jerusalem was Uzzi the son
of Bani, son of Hashabiah, son of Mattaniah, son of Mica, of
the sons of Asaph, the singers, over the work of the house





of God. [23] For there was a command from the king concern-
ing them, and a fixed provision for the singers, as every day
required. [24] And Pethahiah the son of Meshezabel, of the sons
of Zerah the son of Judah, was at the king's side in all matters
concerning the people.

[25] And as for the villages, with their fields, some of the
people of Judah lived in Kiriath-arba and its villages, and in
Dibon and its villages, and in Jekabzeel and its villages, [26] and
in Jeshua and in Moladah and Beth-pelet, [27] in Hazar-shual,
in Beersheba and its villages, [28] in Ziklag, in Meconah and its
villages, [29] in En-rimmon, in Zorah, in Jarmuth, [30] Zanoah,
Adullam, and their villages, Lachish and its fields, and Azekah
and its villages. So they encamped from Beersheba to the Valley
of Hinnom. [31] The people of Benjamin also lived from Geba
onward, at Michmash, Aija, Bethel and its villages, [32] Anathoth,
Nob, Ananiah, [33] Hazor, Ramah, Gittaim, [34] Hadid, Zeboim,
Neballat, [35] Lod, and Ono, the valley of craftsmen. [36] And certain
divisions of the Levites in Judah were assigned to Benjamin.

12 These are the priests and the Levites who came up with
Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua: Seraiah, Jeremiah,
Ezra, [2] Amariah, Malluch, Hattush, [3] Shecaniah, Rehum, Mer-
emoth, [4] Iddo, Ginnethoi, Abijah, [5] Mijamin, Maadiah, Bilgah,
[6] Shemaiah, Joiarib, Jedaiah, [7] Sallu, Amok, Hilkiah, Jedaiah.
These were the chiefs of the priests and of their brothers in
the days of Jeshua.

[8] And the Levites: Jeshua, Binnui, Kadmiel, Sherebiah,
Judah, and Mattaniah, who with his brothers was in charge
of the songs of thanksgiving. [9] And Bakbukiah and Unni and

their brothers stood opposite them in the service. [10] And Jeshua
was the father of Joiakim, Joiakim the father of Eliashib,
Eliashib the father of Joiada, [11] Joiada the father of Jonathan,
and Jonathan the father of Jaddua.

[12] And in the days of Joiakim were priests, heads of fathers'
houses: of Seraiah, Meraiah; of Jeremiah, Hananiah; [13] of Ezra,
Meshullam; of Amariah, Jehohanan; [14] of Malluchi, Jonathan;
of Shebaniah, Joseph; [15] of Harim, Adna; of Meraioth, Helkai;
[16] of Iddo, Zechariah; of Ginnethon, Meshullam; [17] of Abijah,
Zichri; of Miniamin, of Moadiah, Piltai; [18] of Bilgah, Shammua;
of Shemaiah, Jehonathan; [19] of Joiarib, Mattenai; of Jedaiah,
Uzzi; [20] of Sallai, Kallai; of Amok, Eber; [21] of Hilkiah, Hashabiah;
of Jedaiah, Nethanel.

[22] In the days of Eliashib, Joiada, Johanan, and Jaddua, the
Levites were recorded as heads of fathers' houses; so too were
the priests in the reign of Darius the Persian. [23] As for the sons
of Levi, their heads of fathers' houses were written in the
Book of the Chronicles until the days of Johanan the son of
Eliashib. [24] And the chiefs of the Levites: Hashabiah, Sherebiah,
and Jeshua the son of Kadmiel, with their brothers who stood
opposite them, to praise and to give thanks, according to the
commandment of David the man of God, watch by watch.
[25] Mattaniah, Bakbukiah, Obadiah, Meshullam, Talmon, and
Akkub were gatekeepers standing guard at the storehouses of
the gates. [26] These were in the days of Joiakim the son of Jeshua
son of Jozadak, and in the days of Nehemiah the governor and
of Ezra, the priest and scribe.

[27] And at the dedication of the wall of Jerusalem they





sought the Levites in all their places, to bring them to
Jerusalem to celebrate the dedication with gladness, with
thanksgivings and with singing, with cymbals, harps, and
lyres. [28] And the sons of the singers gathered together from
the district surrounding Jerusalem and from the villages
of the Netophathites; [29] also from Beth-gilgal and from the
region of Geba and Azmaveth, for the singers had built for
themselves villages around Jerusalem. [30] And the priests and
the Levites purified themselves, and they purified the people
and the gates and the wall.

[31] Then I brought the leaders of Judah up onto the wall and
appointed two great choirs that gave thanks. One went to the
south on the wall to the Dung Gate. [32] And after them went
Hoshaiah and half of the leaders of Judah, [33] and Azariah, Ezra,
Meshullam, [34] Judah, Benjamin, Shemaiah, and Jeremiah, [35] and
certain of the priests' sons with trumpets: Zechariah the son of
Jonathan, son of Shemaiah, son of Mattaniah, son of Micaiah,
son of Zaccur, son of Asaph; [36] and his relatives, Shemaiah,
Azarel, Milalai, Gilalai, Maai, Nethanel, Judah, and Hanani,
with the musical instruments of David the man of God. And
Ezra the scribe went before them. [37] At the Fountain Gate they
went up straight before them by the stairs of the city of David,
at the ascent of the wall, above the house of David, to the
Water Gate on the east.

[38] The other choir of those who gave thanks went to the
north, and I followed them with half of the people, on the
wall, above the Tower of the Ovens, to the Broad Wall, [39] and
above the Gate of Ephraim, and by the Gate of Yeshanah, and

by the Fish Gate and the Tower of Hananel and the Tower of
the Hundred, to the Sheep Gate; and they came to a halt at the
Gate of the Guard. [40]So both choirs of those who gave thanks
stood in the house of God, and I and half of the officials with
me; [41]and the priests Eliakim, Maaseiah, Miniamin, Micaiah,
Elioenai, Zechariah, and Hananiah, with trumpets; [42]and
Maaseiah, Shemaiah, Eleazar, Uzzi, Jehohanan, Malchijah,
Elam, and Ezer. And the singers sang with Jezrahiah as
their leader. [43]And they offered great sacrifices that day and
rejoiced, for God had made them rejoice with great joy; the
women and children also rejoiced. And the joy of Jerusalem
was heard far away.

[44]On that day men were appointed over the storerooms,
the contributions, the firstfruits, and the tithes, to gather
into them the portions required by the Law for the priests
and for the Levites according to the fields of the towns, for
Judah rejoiced over the priests and the Levites who min-
istered. [45]And they performed the service of their God and
the service of purification, as did the singers and the gate-
keepers, according to the command of David and his son
Solomon. [46]For long ago in the days of David and Asaph
there were directors of the singers, and there were songs of
praise and thanksgiving to God. [47]And all Israel in the days
of Zerubbabel and in the days of Nehemiah gave the daily
portions for the singers and the gatekeepers; and they set
apart that which was for the Levites; and the Levites set apart
that which was for the sons of Aaron.

13 On that day they read from the Book of Moses in the





hearing of the people. And in it was found written that no
Ammonite or Moabite should ever enter the assembly of
God, [2]for they did not meet the people of Israel with bread
and water, but hired Balaam against them to curse them—
yet our God turned the curse into a blessing. [3]As soon as the
people heard the law, they separated from Israel all those of
foreign descent.

[4]Now before this, Eliashib the priest, who was appointed
over the chambers of the house of our God, and who was
related to Tobiah, [5]prepared for Tobiah a large chamber
where they had previously put the grain offering, the frank-
incense, the vessels, and the tithes of grain, wine, and oil,
which were given by commandment to the Levites, singers,
and gatekeepers, and the contributions for the priests. [6]While
this was taking place, I was not in Jerusalem, for in the thirty-
second year of Artaxerxes king of Babylon I went to the king.
And after some time I asked leave of the king [7]and came to
Jerusalem, and I then discovered the evil that Eliashib had
done for Tobiah, preparing for him a chamber in the courts
of the house of God. [8]And I was very angry, and I threw all the
household furniture of Tobiah out of the chamber. [9]Then I
gave orders, and they cleansed the chambers, and I brought
back there the vessels of the house of God, with the grain
offering and the frankincense.

[10]I also found out that the portions of the Levites had not
been given to them, so that the Levites and the singers, who
did the work, had fled each to his field. [11]So I confronted the
officials and said, "Why is the house of God forsaken?" And I

gathered them together and set them in their stations. [12]Then
all Judah brought the tithe of the grain, wine, and oil into the
storehouses. [13]And I appointed as treasurers over the store-
houses Shelemiah the priest, Zadok the scribe, and Pedaiah of
the Levites, and as their assistant Hanan the son of Zaccur, son
of Mattaniah, for they were considered reliable, and their duty
was to distribute to their brothers. [14]Remember me, O my
God, concerning this, and do not wipe out my good deeds
that I have done for the house of my God and for his service.

[15]In those days I saw in Judah people treading winepresses
on the Sabbath, and bringing in heaps of grain and loading
them on donkeys, and also wine, grapes, figs, and all kinds of
loads, which they brought into Jerusalem on the Sabbath day.
And I warned them on the day when they sold food. [16]Tyrians
also, who lived in the city, brought in fish and all kinds of
goods and sold them on the Sabbath to the people of Judah,
in Jerusalem itself! [17]Then I confronted the nobles of Judah
and said to them, "What is this evil thing that you are doing,
profaning the Sabbath day? [18]Did not your fathers act in this
way, and did not our God bring all this disaster on us and on
this city? Now you are bringing more wrath on Israel by pro-
faning the Sabbath."

[19]As soon as it began to grow dark at the gates of Jerusalem
before the Sabbath, I commanded that the doors should be
shut and gave orders that they should not be opened until
after the Sabbath. And I stationed some of my servants at the
gates, that no load might be brought in on the Sabbath day.
[20]Then the merchants and sellers of all kinds of wares lodged





outside Jerusalem once or twice. [21]But I warned them and said
to them, "Why do you lodge outside the wall? If you do so
again, I will lay hands on you." From that time on they did not
come on the Sabbath. [22]Then I commanded the Levites that
they should purify themselves and come and guard the gates,
to keep the Sabbath day holy. Remember this also in my favor,
O my God, and spare me according to the greatness of your
steadfast love.

[23]In those days also I saw the Jews who had married
women of Ashdod, Ammon, and Moab. [24]And half of their
children spoke the language of Ashdod, and they could not
speak the language of Judah, but only the language of each
people. [25]And I confronted them and cursed them and beat
some of them and pulled out their hair. And I made them
take an oath in the name of God, saying, "You shall not give
your daughters to their sons, or take their daughters for your
sons or for yourselves. [26]Did not Solomon king of Israel sin on
account of such women? Among the many nations there was
no king like him, and he was beloved by his God, and God
made him king over all Israel. Nevertheless, foreign women
made even him to sin. [27]Shall we then listen to you and do all
this great evil and act treacherously against our God by mar-
rying foreign women?"

[28]And one of the sons of Jehoiada, the son of Eliashib the
high priest, was the son-in-law of Sanballat the Horonite.
Therefore I chased him from me. [29]Remember them, O my
God, because they have desecrated the priesthood and the
covenant of the priesthood and the Levites.

[30] Thus I cleansed them from everything foreign, and I
established the duties of the priests and Levites, each in his
work; [31] and I provided for the wood offering at appointed
times, and for the firstfruits.

Remember me, O my God, for good.